



PHOTOGRAPHS BY SALWAN GEORGES FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Workers cleaning algae from the Reflecting Pool on Thursday. A cleaning company was awarded a no-bid, \$1.7 million contract.

Firm Hired to Rid Pool of Algae Is Tied to Trump Donor

By DAVID A. FAHRENTHOLD

WASHINGTON — A business tied to a longtime supporter of President Trump was given a no-bid contract to install a water-purification system in the Lincoln Memorial Reflecting Pool this spring.

Now that work is coming under scrutiny after algae blooms have come back and turned the iconic pool in Washington a vibrant shade of green rather than the American-flag blue Mr. Trump says he chose.

The contract shows that the National Park Service bypassed the competitive-bidding process that is typically required, and gave a

\$1.7 million contract to the firm, Greenwater Services of Brookfield, Ohio.

Federal contracting records show that firm's ultimate owner is the J.J. Cafaro Investment Trust, led by John J. Cafaro, a donor to Mr. Trump and a neighbor to Mar-a-Lago, the president's private club in Florida. The water treatment company also listed Mr. Cafaro's Palm Beach mansion as its address in Florida corporate records, and listed his investment trust's phone number and email in Ohio lobbying records.

Mr. Cafaro, a longtime Republican donor whom Mr. Trump has described as a "fantastic man," was once involved in a high-profile bribery scandal. He has also



Recently applied blue paint appeared to be chipping.

donated to Democrats in the past, and his daughter Capri Cafaro served in the Ohio State Senate as a Democrat from 2007 to 2016.

On Thursday, when a photographer for The New York Times vis-

ited the pool, about half of its water remained green, as workers sought to vacuum out algae. Workers have also added hydrogen peroxide to the water in recent days in an attempt to kill the algae, the Interior Department said in an email to The Times.

The department, which oversees the National Park Service, said that the firm had already brought temporary water-purification sites to the pool, and that it was expected to install a permanent system this week.

Katie Martin, a spokeswoman for the department, declined to say why the Park Service had refilled the pool before the permanent system was in place — rais-

Continued on Page A12



RUTH FREMSON/THE NEW YORK TIMES

Star-Spangled Win Without a Star

The U.S. team, despite losing Christian Pulisic, advanced at the World Cup with a 2-0 win over Australia. Coverage at [nytimes.com](#).

Bagpipes and Kilts Charm Boston as Scots Strain the Beer Supply

By MARK ARSENAULT

BOSTON — The city of Boston is in the midst of a benevolent invasion of gregarious, kilted visitors, who smell vaguely of pale lager and speak a lyrical language that, as it turns out, is English.

The Tartan Army — thousands of soccer fans from Scotland, here to see their national team play outside Boston in two matches of the World Cup — are packing this

old city's narrow streets, its subway cars, restaurants and pubs, and filling the air with the cry of bagpipes. The Scots are bursting out of historic Faneuil Hall, and the less historic but maybe more famous Cheers bar.

They have put a serious dent in the region's strategic beer reserves, and have become social media darlings, as they gently prank their hosts by dunce-capping statues with traffic cones.

World Cup Brings the Tartan Army to Town

On Sunday, they marched en masse to Scottish heritage night at Fenway Park, electrifying a ho-hum midseason matchup between the Boston Red Sox and the Texas Rangers.

At the game, they sang their

way into all-time Red Sox lore with a full-hearted rendition of "I'm Gonna Be (500 Miles)," the '80s hit by the Scottish duo the Proclaimers.

Across a city where residents are known as provincial and proudly skilled in the art of gripe, the locals have been thoroughly charmed by the joyful Scottish occupation.

The question on many sets of

Continued on Page A15

A Wobbly Start to a Truce After Fighting in Lebanon

Israel Announces Cease-Fire After Strikes Jeopardized U.S. Talks With Iran

This article is by **Abdi Latif Dahir, Euan Ward, Adam Rasgon, Johnatan Reiss and Richard Pérez-Peña.**

BEIRUT, Lebanon — Diplomats worked on Friday to try to keep the fragile deal between Iran and the United States on track, after Israeli strikes in Lebanon prompted Iran to pull out of peace talks. Hours later, Israel said it had agreed to a cease-fire in Lebanon with Iran's ally, Hezbollah.

Iran's withdrawal from talks with the United States, even if temporary, dealt a blow to the framework agreement signed this week by President Trump. Negotiations for a long-term peace agreement had been expected to start just hours later in Switzerland.

But if the already shaky truce with Iran wobbled, it apparently held, for now, with no suggestion that talks had been put off indefinitely. Shipping traffic through the Strait of Hormuz continued to increase, though it remained far below its prewar level.

Israel's ambassador to the United States, Yechiel Leiter, confirmed that his country was "firmly committed to an immediate cease-fire." Mr. Trump told NBC News in a phone call that he had asked Israeli leaders on Friday to agree to a cease-fire in Lebanon, which he called "a little icing on the cake," but did not say if he

had spoken with Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu. Hezbollah has not publicly confirmed that it agreed to a cease-fire.

The day's events demonstrated how delicate the U.S.-Iran agreement reached this week remains, and how central Lebanon is to it. The first of its 14 points commits both countries "and their allies in the current war" to "the immediate and permanent termination of military operations on all fronts, including in Lebanon." But neither Israel, which went to war against Iran along with the United States, nor Hezbollah, backed by Iran, has signed on to the agreement.

Lebanon was relatively quiet in the hours after the cease-fire there was to take effect, at 4 p.m. local time. It followed an intense round of Israeli bombing during the night that killed 47 people and wounded 97, according to Lebanon's health ministry, which does not distinguish between civilians and combatants. Officials from multiple countries confirmed the cease-fire, which they said was brokered by Qatar and the United States. They, along with those who confirmed the Iranian withdrawal from talks, spoke on the condition of anonymity to discuss sensitive diplomacy.

Iran insists that any short- or long-term peace agreement include Lebanon. But Israel's gov-

Continued on Page A8

LAST-MINUTE DEAL The U.S.-Iran agreement, which punted many of the toughest issues to future talks, came after a late scramble. [PAGE A8](#)

STUCK IN GULF Shipping companies had hoped to get their ships out after a U.S.-Iran deal but faced uncertainty as violence reignited. [PAGE B1](#)

A Difficult Rite In France Asks: Who Are We?

By CATHERINE PORTER

PARIS — The French were grappling with two questions this week. Not whether President Trump would hurl insults and leave the Group of 7 early or who the least-known player in the World Cup is. Instead, they were asking: Can one be happy when others are not? And, do we have control of our words?

The questions were part of this year's written test in philosophy, taken at the exact same time each year around the country by more than a half-million 17- and 18-year-olds. The students, who have spent all year taking a required course in philosophy, have to answer one of two questions, or dissect a philosophical tract. This year, the tract came from Friedrich Nietzsche's 1878 book, "Human, All Too Human."

Students have four hours to write their responses. The exam is such an important part of French education that local news outlets commit live-blogs to it, beside their rolling updates on the wars in Iran and Ukraine, and invite philosophers to discuss their own responses to the questions.

"For me, the philosophy exam says everything about who we are," said Édouard Geffray, France's education minister. He was speaking from the yard of a high school he visited on Monday to crack open exam packages in front of television cameras and pass them out to students, and also to offer some last-minute nonphilosophical advice about proofreading.

The exam, he said, "actually says that we are a country in which we have chosen to put the

Continued on Page A10

ICE to Offload Sites It Bought At \$700 Million

By HAMED ALEAZIZ

WASHINGTON — The idea was meant to supercharge President Trump's mass deportation plan.

Immigration and Customs Enforcement would purchase more than a dozen empty warehouses across the United States to massively expand its capacity to detain people deemed to be in the country illegally, which in turn would spike deportations. A year into Mr. Trump's term, it had bought 11 facilities at a cost of \$1 billion.

But in a major turnabout, the agency is planning to offload seven warehouses purchased for more than \$700 million by either giving them to other federal agencies or selling them outright, according to documents obtained by The New York Times.

The decision to sharply scale back the warehouse plan is a rejection of a signature initiative under the previous homeland security secretary, Kristi Noem, who pushed the boundaries of what the government can do to aggressively round up potential deportees. The new secretary, Markwayne Mullin, who had privately expressed skepticism about the plan, has said publicly that he wants the agency to be quieter about how it carries out immigration enforcement.

"From Day 1, D.H.S. has remained singularly focused on removing the worst of the worst criminal illegal aliens from the United States and is always evaluating the best methods to do so," the Homeland Security Department said in a statement for this article. "These heinous criminals,

Continued on Page A12



ARTS C1-6

From the Court to the Stage

To handle jitters about her Broadway debut, Mariska Hargitay is taking inspiration from the Knicks. [PAGE C1](#)

Low Energy, Big Laughs

Aaron Chen and Dan Mintz specialize in stand-up comedy that upends and even satirizes expectations. [PAGE C1](#)

INTERNATIONAL A4-10

Differing Views of Director

Alexander Sokurov has questioned the Russian president about government repression, but he is still controversial among his country's exiles. [PAGE A4](#)

Ukraine's Missing Ingredient

Military experts say that Ukraine needs ballistic missiles to push Russia to rethink its war objectives. [PAGE A6](#)

SPORTS B6-9

Are the Knicks America's Team?

The N.B.A. champs became the rare New York City team to garner love from beyond the five boroughs. [PAGE B7](#)



BUSINESS B1-5

For Sale: LaGuardia Flights

Spirit Airlines's demise leaves a coveted place at one of the New York area's main airports up for grabs. [PAGE B1](#)

Congress Wary in Trade Talks

As midterms loom, some lawmakers are apprehensive over the direction of U.S.-Canada-Mexico negotiations. [PAGE B1](#)

NATIONAL A11-17, 20

Mining the Bottom of the Sea

Valuable metals lie untouched in the seabed of the Pacific Ocean. But obtaining them could ravage deep-sea life nearby. The United States is moving ahead despite opposition. [PAGE A14](#)

The Split Over America's 250th

President Trump sidestepped a congressional commission to form his own group to plan festivities. The result is a partisan celebration, disgruntled celebrities and plenty of confusion. [PAGE A11](#)

OPINION A18-19

Thomas L. Friedman [PAGE A18](#)

THE MAGAZINE

THIS WEEKEND

0 354613 9